

The AI Toolkit / Slides, Content & Research

A quick-reference to the tools worth reaching for when you're building presentations, writing material, and researching a topic — organised by the job you need done.

16 TOOLS

5 CATEGORIES

UPDATED AUGUST 2026

SECTION 01 · 6 TOOLS

Presentations & Slides

Turn ideas — or whole prompts — into finished decks

01 Gamma

DECK GENERATION

Full decks from a single prompt — proposals, reports, pitch decks, class slides.

Free

Paid \$10–20/mo

● Best overall AI deck generator

02 Canva AI

PRESENTATION DESIGN

Slide templates, posters, resumes and social graphics in one place.

Free

Pro \$15/mo

● Best for designers & teachers

03 Beautiful.ai

BUSINESS PRESENTATIONS

Polished corporate decks, company reports and investor decks.

Paid \$12–45/mo

● Best for corporate decks

04 Microsoft Copilot

POWERPOINT AUTOMATION

Build and summarise slides directly inside Microsoft Office.

M365 + Copilot \$30/mo

● Best for Office users

05 Presentations.AI

AI SLIDE CREATION

Auto-built modern slides with animation, hands-off.

Free

Paid

● Best Gamma alternative

06 Tome AI

STORYTELLING DECKS

Narrative pitches and product walkthroughs.

Free

Paid

● Best for storytelling

SECTION 02 · 3 TOOLS

Content & Writing

Draft the words before you design the slides

01 ChatGPT

CONTENT GENERATION

Lesson notes, reports, documentation, blogs and code.

Free

Plus \$20/mo

● Best all-round content generator

02 Claude AI

LONG-FORM WRITING

Books, research papers and technical documentation.

Free

Pro \$20/mo

● Best for long documents

03 Google Gemini

RESEARCH & WORKSPACE

Research, coding and educational content, wired into Google Workspace.

Free

AI Pro \$20/mo

● Best in the Google ecosystem

Research & Study

Gather sources and turn dense material into study aids

01

Perplexity AI
RESEARCH WITH SOURCES
Literature review, market research and answers with citations.

FreePro \$20/mo

● Best research assistant

02

NotebookLM
STUDY MATERIAL
Turn PDFs into notes, FAQs, study guides and podcasts.

FreeGoogle AI Pro

● Best for students & teachers

Visuals & Diagrams

Make the abstract legible — flows, charts, infographics

01

Napkin AI
DIAGRAMS FROM TEXT
Flowcharts, mind maps and diagrams straight from plain text.

FreePaid

● Best diagram generator

02

Visme
INFOGRAPHICS
Infographics, reports, dashboards and teaching visuals.

FreePaid

● Best for infographics

03

Infogram
DATA VISUALISATION
Charts, dashboards and business reports.

FreePaid

● Best for data viz

Design & Images

Generate the artwork the slides and posters need

01

Adobe Express AI
CREATIVE DESIGN
Marketing graphics, slides and posters.

FreePremium

● Best Adobe-style alternative

02

Ideogram AI
TEXT-IN-IMAGE GENERATION
Posters and banners with clean, legible text.

FreePaid

● Best image generator for text

DECISION SHORTCUT

Quick pick by need

Auto-generate a PowerPoint	Gamma
Professional business deck	Beautiful.ai
Educational slides	Gamma + Canva AI
Research with citations	Perplexity AI
Complete lesson notes	ChatGPT
Write a book / manuscript	Claude AI
Create diagrams	Napkin AI
Create infographics	Visme
Charts & dashboards	Infogram
Google Workspace user	Google Gemini
Microsoft Office user	Microsoft Copilot
Turn PDFs into notes	NotebookLM
Generate AI images	Ideogram AI
Social posts + slides	Canva AI

CATEGORY WINNERS

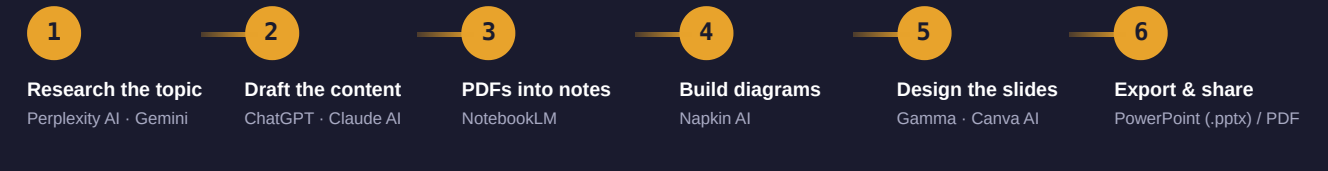
If you only remember one per job

AI presentation generator	Gamma
AI content writer	ChatGPT
Long-form writing	Claude AI
Research tool	Perplexity AI
PowerPoint tool	Microsoft Copilot
Free presentation tool	Canva AI
Diagram tool	Napkin AI
PDF note generator	NotebookLM
Business presentation	Beautiful.ai
Image generator	Ideogram AI

THE PIPELINE

A trainer's end-to-end workflow

Research to finished deck, moving left to right — pick one tool at each stage.



Pricing is approximate and changes often — always confirm the current plan on each vendor's official site before you buy. Tool positioning reflects a general view at the time of writing, not a formal benchmark.